

COURSE FILE

PC749: Image, Text & Sound

Credit Structure: 3-0-4-5

Program: MDes (Communication Design)

Year: 1

Semester: 1

Duration: 18 Days (Full Day – Lecture + Studio)

Timing: 9 AM – 6 PM

Course Instructor: Anirban Dutta Gupta

Couse Placement: Core course for MDes (CD) Semester 1. This is a foundational course in design and is aimed to integrate the inputs in the previous courses into a ‘multimedia’ matrix and orient the students to the application oriented Semester 2 that follows.

Course Format: Module based. The course is taught as a combination of Lectures and Studio sessions. Lectures introduce concepts, which are then analysed and explored via studio sessions and assignments. Lecture and studio is integrated and in certain cases can overlap. Teaching is through hand-on learning and through learning-by-doing and via real-time demonstrations and guidance by faculty members. Students will be expected to fieldwork.

Course Objective and Content:

This course aims to introduce to elements of multi-media in Communication Design. It will encourage students to explore how words, images and sounds are put together for a range of communication events and forms. Students would be expected to observe, research, document and compose presentations deploying multi-media. They will be encouraged to read and explore ideas from design aesthetics and semiotics to understand compositional

styles and aesthetic choices in traditional as well as contemporary forms of communication media in which visual, verbal and aural elements are combined to make effective communication events. Students would be able to appreciate diverse technologies of communication in rural or urban, India or in local or global media platforms and explore how image, text and sounds are combined to generate a context-specific meaning in specific contexts. This could be exemplified in case of advertisements, mounting of event such as theatrical, exhibition, and installation or ritual performances. By the end of the semester students are expected to acquire the skills and the theoretical insights that are needed to understand the relationships between composition and context in multimedia formats.

In communication design, the integration of image, text, and sound is essential to creating effective, engaging, and immersive user experiences. This course investigates the individual and collective roles of these three elements in crafting messages that resonate emotionally, intellectually, and sensorially with the audience. The synergy between these elements results in a more comprehensive and powerful communication design, one that goes beyond traditional, single-sensory approaches to deliver a richer, multisensory experience to effectively convey messages, elicit responses, and shape user experiences. The fusion of image, text, and sound plays a pivotal role in determining the effectiveness of a design. While each element serves distinct functions, their interaction creates a more nuanced and dynamic experience that is capable of engaging multiple senses simultaneously.

Images are integral to communication design because they convey meaning and emotion with immediacy. The power of visual imagery lies in its ability to transcend linguistic barriers and communicate universal concepts. Photographs, illustrations, icons, and graphics all contribute to the design by evoking emotional responses, by simplifying complex information and by providing context and meaning. Images establish the setting, provide visual cues, and help to reinforce or even redefine the message conveyed by accompanying text.

Text remains the primary medium for delivering detailed information, articulating complex ideas, and guiding audience understanding. While images and sound evoke emotions and

set tone, text provides the clarity and specificity necessary for the effective transmission of key messages. The strategic use of typography (comprehensively studied and deployed in Fundamentals of Design 2) and written language offers several advantages in communication design through clearly conveying information, by setting tone and voice, by enhancing accessibility through more legible text design, and finally, by providing structure and navigation through an organizational framework within a design.

Sound is an often-overlooked yet powerful element of communication design, particularly in digital and multimedia contexts. It adds an additional layer of sensory engagement that heightens emotional connection and enhances the user experience. The use of sound effects, music, and spoken word in design helps to enhance emotional engagement, establish atmosphere and immersion, especially seen in films and in multimedia applications, games, and websites and in the digital realm support user interaction through haptic feedbacks.

When combined, image, text, and sound can create a powerful, unified communication design platform. The interaction of these elements enables designers to convey messages that are not only clear and informative but also emotionally compelling and immersive. The integration of these media offers several advantages through multisensory engagement, memory retention and recall, enhanced emotional impact and an improved user experience.

Knowledge and Skill targets:

Knowledge:

1. Understanding sound
2. Diegetic, Non-Diegetic, Trans-diegetic and Intra-Diegetic sound
3. Sound and emotion
4. Visualising and planning sound
5. Sound, Image, Text and culture
6. Impact of sound, image and text in communication design

7. Deploying as multimedia assets
8. Seamless user experience design
9. Recap of typographic concepts from FOD 2
10. Recap of visual design concepts from FOD 1 and FOD 2
11. Recap of History of Design

Skill:

1. Appreciating sound scape
2. Recording and creating soundscape
3. Integrating image and sound
4. Sound and image editing software
5. Multimedia integration software
6. Organising sound recording setup

Software's:

1. Adobe Premiere Pro
2. Adobe Animate
3. Adobe Audition
4. Audacity

Hardware:

1. Sound recording equipment's (zoom mic, microphones, boom rods etc.)
2. Sound studio

Assessment Method: Continuous assessment of application of concepts through the duration of the course, along with assessment of group and individual assignments given. Assessment will not only cover the assignments, but professionalism, precision, pride, care and discipline displayed by the students.

P1	P2	P3	P4	P5	P6	P7	P8	P9	P10	P11	P12
	X	X	X	X		X	X	X	X	X	X

Course Outcome: The strategic use of image, text, and sound in communication design is fundamental to creating designs that are effective, engaging, and memorable. These elements, when used independently or in combination, enhance emotional engagement, clarify complex ideas, establish brand identities, and create immersive experiences. The synergy between image, text, and sound forms the backbone of modern communication design, offering a more dynamic and multisensory approach to conveying messages. By understanding the distinct and collective roles of these elements, designers can craft powerful, user-centered designs that resonate deeply with diverse audiences. This course is the pre-cursor course to more complex and challenging courses like Fundamentals of Filmmaking (Semester 2), Interaction Design (Semester 2) and Animation and Motion Graphics (Semester 3)

Growth Matrix:

Flow	Objectives
1	Growth Matrix 1: Understanding multimedia – exploring different modalities and synchronicity. Objective: To understand and appreciate the integrated nature of multimedia communication – as exists in our surrounding and as a way to replicate an experience
2	Growth Matrix 2: Understanding Sound as part of multimedia experience.

	Objective: To understand and appreciate the how sound is structured and layered as part of audio modality.
3	Growth Matrix 3: Recording sound Objective: To understand how to deconstruct and reconstruct sound
4	Growth Matrix 4: Integrating sound with image(s) Objective: Adding an additional layer of sensorial information to emphasise the communication
5	Growth Matrix 5: Integrating text with sound and image to create a multimedia experience Objective: Multi-modal nature of communication design integrating text, image and audio
6	Growth Matrix 6: Integrating sound, text with group of images to create a title sequence or an immersive multimodal experience Objective: Integrating image, text and sound for a specific culture-specific edutainment communication package

Some things to keep in mind:

- Attendance is mandatory. You will have to be present during class hours.
- All assignments have to be completed.
- Use of any form of AI tools to generate concepts is strictly forbidden unless discussed in class and allowed for the specific assignment.

Reference:

- *Audio-Vision: Sound on Screen* by Michel Chion

- *The Visual Story: Creating the Visual Structure of Film, TV and Digital Media* by Bruce A. Block
 - *Sound and Image: Aesthetics and Practices* edited by Andrew Knight-Hill
 - *Writing for Visual Media* by Anthony Friedmann
 - *The Sound Effects Bible: How to Create and Record Hollywood Style Sound Effects* by Ric Viers
 - *Visual Culture: The Study of the Visual after the Cultural Turn* by Irit Rogoff
 - *The Oxford Handbook of Sound and Image in Digital Media* edited by Carol Vernallis, Amy Herzog, and John Richardson
 - *The Soundscape: Our Sonic Environment and the Tuning of the World* by R. Murray Schafer
 - *Sounding Out! The Practice and Politics of Listening* edited by Michele Hilmes and Jason Loviglio
 - *The Audible Past: Cultural Origins of Sound Reproduction* by Jonathan Sterne
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